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PdfBooklet

Turn any PDF into a print-ready booklet

PdfBooklet puts two pages on each side of a sheet, in the order that makes them read correctly once the stack is folded in the middle. Open a PDF, adjust the settings, and export.

This guide is also the sample file. It has exactly 8 pages, which makes two sheets with no blank pages. Import it into PdfBooklet, look at the preview, export it and print it. The checklist on the last page tells you what you should see.

Version 1.0.0.0 · AGPL-3.0 · github.com/fuszenecker/PdfBooklet

Quick start

The window has three square buttons. Use them from left to right.



1 Import

Pick the PDF you want to turn into a booklet. PdfBooklet reads the page sizes and immediately shows how the pages will be laid out. You can also start the program with a file name: `pdfbooklet file.pdf`.



2 Settings

Choose the paper size, binding, margins, scale, alignment and output options. The preview updates when you press OK, and the choices are remembered for next time.

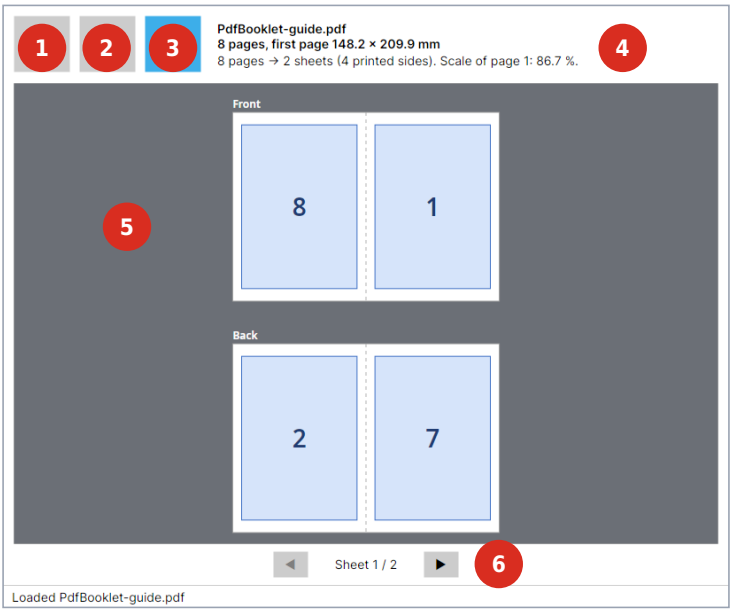


3 Export

Choose where to save the booklet PDF. Print it double-sided, or tick *Manual duplex* in the settings first if your printer only prints on one side (see page 7).

The original file is never modified, and PdfBooklet refuses to overwrite it. The export button stays disabled until a PDF is loaded and the settings are valid.

The main window

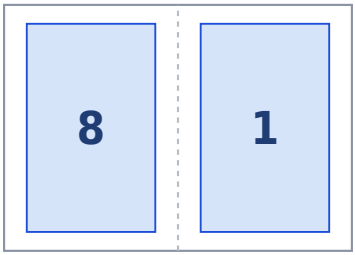


1. **Import** a PDF.
2. **Settings** for the sheet, layout and output.
3. **Export** the booklet. It lights up once there is something to export.
4. File name, page count and size of the first page, then a summary: sheets, printed sides, blank pages added and the scale of page 1. A red message appears here when the settings cannot work.
5. **Preview** of one sheet, front above and back below, exactly as it will be exported. Numbers are pages of your PDF; dashed boxes are blank pages added to fill the booklet.
6. **Arrows** to step through all the sheets.

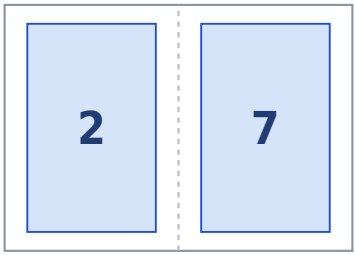
How a booklet is made

A booklet sheet carries two pages on each side. The sheets are stacked, folded in the middle and the pages fall into reading order. This guide has 8 pages, so it needs 2 sheets, which is 4 printed sides:

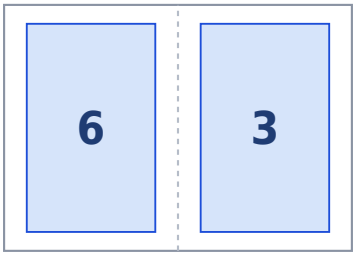
Sheet 1 – front



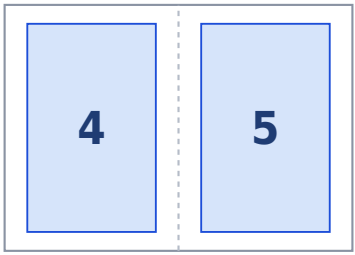
Sheet 1 – back



Sheet 2 – front

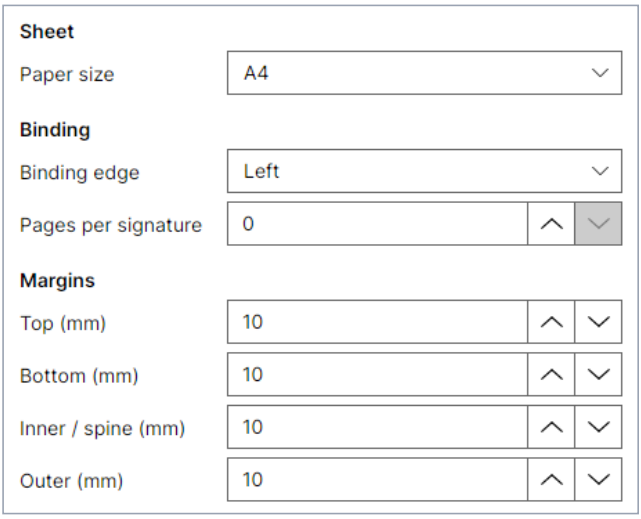


Sheet 2 – back



- The outermost sheet carries the last page next to the first. Each sheet further in carries the next pair of pages.
- When the page count is not a multiple of 4, PdfBooklet adds blank pages at the end (dashed in the preview).
- **Pages per signature** splits a long document into separate folded groups. With 16, each group of 4 sheets is folded and stapled on its own; with 0 the whole document is one group.
- **Binding edge: Right** mirrors every side, for books that read from right to left.

Sheet, binding, margins



Sheet

Paper size is the physical sheet: A3, A4, A5, Letter, Legal, Tabloid or Custom (50 to 2000 mm). Sheets are always landscape, because two pages sit side by side. Pages are scaled to fit, so any source size works; with zero margins, A5 pages fill A4 sheets at 100 %.

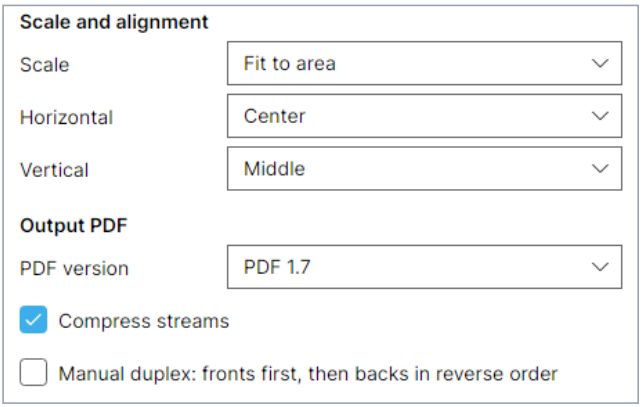
Binding

Binding edge: Left for books read left to right, Right for right to left.
Pages per signature: 0 folds everything as one group, otherwise a multiple of 4.

Margins

Top, bottom, inner (between a page and the fold) and outer (between a page and the sheet edge), in millimetres. Most printers cannot print the outermost 4 to 6 mm.

Scale, alignment, output



Scale and alignment

Fit to area scales every page up or down to fill the space inside the margins. **Actual size** keeps 100 % and clips what does not fit. **Custom** takes a percentage from 1 to 1000. **Horizontal** alignment (inner, center, outer) is mirrored on the two pages; **Vertical** is top, middle or bottom. Alignment matters when a page is smaller than the area.

Output PDF

PDF version 1.4 to 1.7 sets the file header only; PDF/A is not supported. **Compress streams** makes smaller files. **Manual duplex** is for single-sided printers (next page).

Settings that cannot work (negative margins, a signature size that is not a multiple of 4, margins that leave no room) show the reason and disable OK.

Printing the booklet

Duplex printer

Print the exported PDF as it is: double-sided, **flip on short edge**, scale **100 % / actual size** (not “fit to page”), paper size equal to the sheet size you chose.

Single-sided printer

Tick **Manual duplex** in the settings before exporting. The PDF then holds all fronts first, then all backs in reverse order:

1. Print the first half of the pages (fronts).
2. Turn the whole stack over around its short edge and put it back in the tray.
3. Print the second half (backs).

For this 8-page guide the exported PDF has 4 pages: print pages 1–2, turn the stack over, then print pages 3–4. Finally fold the stack in half and staple along the fold.

If it comes out wrong

- Backs upside down: turn the stack over around the other edge.
- Backs in the wrong order: your printer feeds the other way. Print the second half again with your viewer’s “reverse order” option.
- Always test with this guide first: it takes only two sheets.

Checklist

What you should see with this guide (left binding, A4 sheets):

Page	Duplex order	Manual duplex order
1	Sheet 1 front: 8 | 1	Sheet 1 front: 8 | 1
2	Sheet 1 back: 2 | 7	Sheet 2 front: 6 | 3
3	Sheet 2 front: 6 | 3	Sheet 2 back: 4 | 5
4	Sheet 2 back: 4 | 5	Sheet 1 back: 2 | 7

☐ The import summary says **8 pages → 2 sheets (4 printed sides)**, with no blank pages.

☐ The exported PDF has 4 landscape pages in the order above.

☐ Printed double-sided and folded, the pages read 1 to 8 in order.

☐ With binding Right, the two pages of every side swap places.

☐ The thin frame around each page is fully visible, so nothing is clipped.

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